

Vendor Onboarding Guide

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1. Overview

This guide outlines the standard process for onboarding new vendors. All vendors must complete this process before purchase orders can be issued. The onboarding process typically takes 2-4 weeks depending on vendor category and complexity.

2. Vendor Categories

Category	Risk Level	Additional Requirements
Technology	High	Security assessment, data handling review
Office Supplies	Low	Standard documentation only
Staffing	Medium	Background checks, insurance verification
Facilities	Medium	Insurance, safety certifications
Food Services	Low	Health permits, insurance
Legal	High	Conflict of interest check, NDA

3. Required Documentation

All vendors must submit the following documentation: (a) Completed vendor registration form, (b) W-9 form (domestic) or W-8BEN (international), (c) Certificate of insurance with minimum \$1M general liability coverage, (d) Banking information for ACH payments, (e) Signed master service agreement or purchase terms. Technology vendors must additionally provide SOC 2 Type II report or equivalent security certification.

4. Approval Workflow

Step 1: Requesting department submits vendor request via procurement portal. Step 2: Operations team conducts initial screening (1-2 business days). Step 3: Category-specific assessments are initiated. Step 4: Legal reviews contract terms (3-5 business days for standard contracts). Step 5: Finance sets up vendor in payment system. Step 6: Vendor receives welcome packet and primary contact information. Total timeline: 10-20 business days depending on vendor category.

5. Performance Monitoring

All active vendors are reviewed quarterly using the following criteria: delivery timeliness, invoice accuracy, quality of goods/services, responsiveness to issues, and contract compliance. Vendors scoring below 3.0 out of 5.0 on the quarterly review will be placed on a performance improvement plan. Vendors failing to improve within two consecutive quarters may have their contracts terminated.

6. Inactive Vendor Reactivation

Vendors marked as inactive (no POs in 12 months) must complete a simplified reactivation process: (a) Updated insurance certificates, (b) Confirmation of banking details, (c) Review of any contract amendments. Reactivation typically takes 3-5 business days. If the vendor has been inactive for more than 24 months, full re-onboarding is required.